

BM3 — Lesson 2: Abigail

Wisdom on the Move

 **Background Text:** 1 Samuel 25:2–39; Proverbs 15:1 (WEB)

 **Key Verse:** Proverbs 15:1

“A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger.”

 ***Wisdom in motion: faith that chooses peace over pride.***

 **Appetizer – The Courage to Step In, 1 Samuel 25:18–20 (WEB)**

“Then Abigail hurried and took two hundred loaves of bread, two containers of wine, five sheep ready dressed, five seahs of parched grain, one hundred clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid them on donkeys. She said to her young men, ‘Go on before me. Behold, I come after you.’ But she didn’t tell her husband, Nabal.

It was so, as she rode on her donkey, and came down by the covert of the mountain, that behold, David and his men came down toward her; and she met them.”

Abigail wasted no time. She quickly gathered two hundred loaves of bread, two containers of wine, five prepared sheep, roasted grain, clusters of raisins, and cakes of figs. She packed them on donkeys and said to her servants, “Go on ahead. I will follow you shortly.” But she didn’t tell her husband Nabal what she was doing. Sometimes moving strategically is moving stealthily!

 **CST**

Abigail didn’t wait for permission to do what was right. She used foresight—seeing danger ahead and acting to prevent disaster. Her faith wasn’t just belief; it was movement toward peace.

 **Reflection Question**

When was the last time you acted on faith to prevent harm or conflict?

Main Course

Bite 1 – The Folly of Nabal, 1 Samuel 25:10–11, 14–17 (WEB)

“Nabal answered David’s servants, and said, ‘Who is David? Who is the son of Jesse? There are many servants who break away from their masters these days. Shall I then take my bread, my water, and my meat that I have killed for my shearers, and give it to men who I don’t know where they come from?’”

Later, one of Nabal’s servants told Abigail how David’s men had been good to them in the fields, how they had not been harmed or stolen from, and yet Nabal “rushed on them” with insults. He warned her that disaster was hanging over the household because Nabal was such a worthless man “that one can’t speak to him”

CST

Nabal’s arrogance created a crisis. Foolish pride will always test someone’s faith. Abigail’s faith met that test with wisdom, not words of war. The bible says in James 1:19-20 (KJV, paraphrased), that we should be ‘quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to wrath. Because the wrath of man doesn’t produce the righteousness of God. Nabal wasn’t trying to hear anyone of reason and sometimes we hear through emotional filters, and it is important for us to identify and call out these barriers to the truth, just like Nabal’s servants did to Abigail.

Reflection Question

Have you ever had to respond to someone’s anger or disrespect with peace instead of pride?

Bite 2 – Faith in Action, 1 Samuel 25:23–31 (WEB)

“When Abigail saw David, she hurried, and alighted from her donkey, and fell before David on her face, and bowed herself to the ground. She fell at his feet, and said, ‘On me, my lord, on me be the iniquity; and please let your handmaid speak in your ears. Hear the words of your handmaid. Please don’t let my lord pay attention to this worthless fellow, Nabal; for as his name is, so is he. Nabal is his name, and folly is with him...’”

When Abigail saw David, she quickly got off her donkey and bowed low before him. She fell at his feet and said, “I accept all blame in this matter, my lord. Please listen to what I have to say... When the Lord has done all He promised and has made you leader of Israel, don’t let this be a blemish on your record.”

She strategically pointed David back to God’s promise over his life—that Yahweh would surely make him ruler over Israel. She urged him not to carry needless bloodshed or vengeance on his record when that day came.

CST

Abigail took on the blame for her husband’s offense—an act of courage and foresight. She spoke life into David’s calling instead of fueling his wrath. Her humility redirected the entire situation.

Reflection Questions

- What does it mean to “stand in the gap” for someone else’s mistake?

- Have you ever had to de-escalate a situation you didn’t cause?

- Did your response bring God honor or dishonor?

Bite 3 – A Wise Outcome, 1 Samuel 25:32–35 (WEB)

“David said to Abigail, ‘Blessed is Yahweh, the God of Israel, who sent you today to meet me! Blessed is your discretion, and blessed are you, who have kept me today from blood guiltiness, and from avenging myself with my own hand.... I have listened to your voice, and have accepted your person.’ So David received from her hand that which she had brought him. Then he said to her, ‘Go up in peace to your house. Behold, I have listened to your voice, and have granted your request.’”

David replied to Abigail, “Praise the Lord, the God of Israel, who has sent you to meet me today! Thank God for your good sense! David is a sensible guy. The same one that stood up for the people of God and Bless you for keeping me from murder and from carrying out vengeance with my own hands.” Then David accepted her gifts and told her, “Return home in peace. I have heard what you said. We will not kill your husband.” If he didn’t kill Saul, David was truly after peace and support for the men who supported others- nothing more.

CST

One act of wisdom can save an entire household. Faith foresaw danger; wisdom found peace. Abigail's actions honored God, David, and her own integrity.

Reflection Question

What would the world look like if more of us prayed for wisdom before reacting?

Dessert – The Aftermath of Obedience (1 Samuel 25:38–39, WEB)

“About ten days later, Yahweh struck Nabal, so that he died. When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, ‘Blessed be Yahweh, who has pleaded the cause of my reproach from the hand of Nabal, and has kept back his servant from evil.’”

About ten days later, the Lord struck Nabal, and he died. When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, “Praise the Lord, who has avenged the insult I received from Nabal and has kept me from doing it myself.” Then David sent messengers to propose marriage to Abigail.

CST

When God vindicates, He also elevates. Abigail's humility brought her favor—she went from the wife of a fool to the bride of a future king.

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight are more than belief—they are wisdom in motion.
- Pride creates unnecessary battles; humility opens unexpected doors.
- When we humble ourselves and act with discernment, God can turn conflict into protection and even promotion.

Closing Prayer (Abigail – Wisdom on the Move)

“Lord, thank You for Abigail’s example of wisdom and courage. Help me respond with grace when other people’s foolishness creates messes around me. Teach me to honor You, treat Your people well, and trust You to handle what I can’t. In Jesus’ name, amen.

Word Study

- **Abigail (Hebrew: אַבִּיגַיִל – “Avigayil”)** — “My father’s joy” or “source of joy.” Her character embodied the beauty of her name; she became a channel of peace and joy even in chaos.
- **Nabal (Hebrew: נָבָל – “Nabal”)** — “Foolish” or “senseless.” His actions reflected his name, showing how arrogance blinds us to wisdom and leads to destruction.
- **Scapegoat (Hebrew: עֲזָאזֵל – “Azazel”)** — From Leviticus 16, referring to the goat released into the wilderness carrying the sins of the people. Symbolically, Abigail bore the “guilt” of her household to intercede for peace.
- **Foresight** — Spiritual sensitivity that anticipates and prepares for what God is revealing ahead of time.

Write one line about where you need *foresight* right now:

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with _____ and faith, not fear.
2. Nabal's pride led to his _____.
3. David praised God for Abigail's _____.
4. Abigail's wisdom prevented _____ and brought peace.

(Check answers in the Appendix)

Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study
